



# Evening and Afterhours Responsibilities relating to Mental Health Hospital in The Home (MHHiTH) (Mental Health) Guideline

## Preamble

### Consumer Participation

The Rockingham Peel Group (RKPG) recognises and fully supports the need for the patient and/or their primary carer to<sup>1</sup>:

- Know and exercise their healthcare rights.
- Be engaged in their healthcare.
- Have access to information about treatment options.
- Participate in treatment decisions.
- Have access to information about agreed treatment plans.

### Scope of Practice

It is the responsibility of each health care provider to ensure all patient care and therapeutic interventions they provide are within their individual scope of practice. Refer to the [RKPG Policy Writing Guide Summary](#) for further information about Scope of Practice.

## Mission of Service

To offer a contemporary, recovery-oriented alternative to inpatient admission for RKPG mental health patients by providing safe, high quality, evidence based and responsive mental health hospital level care in their home or usual place of residence.

## Aim

The following guideline is specific to the operations based in the 'Evening service' and 'Afterhours Support'.

## Risk

Failure to adhere to these guidelines may result in adverse clinical events for patients and risk of harm/injury to staff.

## Definitions

The MHHiTH service will be divided into separate service times:

- **In hours** - commencing at 08:00hrs and finishing at 17:00hrs.
- **Evening service** - commencing at 17:00hrs and finishing at 20:30hrs.
- **Afterhours support** - response to afterhours urgent or crisis calls for MHHiTH patient, hours from at 20:30hrs and finishing at 08:00hrs.
- **Weekend/Public Holiday service** –Saturday, Sunday and Public Holiday.

| RESPONSIBILITY    |                                                                                                                           |              |          | NATIONAL STANDARDS<br><br>1, 5, 6 |
|-------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|--------------|----------|-----------------------------------|
| First Issued      | Mar 2021                                                                                                                  | Revisions    | NA       |                                   |
| This version      | Sep 2021                                                                                                                  | Revision Due | Sep 2024 |                                   |
| Responsibility of | Co-Directors Mental Health                                                                                                | Endorsed by  | DONM/DCS |                                   |
| Title             | Evening and Afterhours Responsibilities relating to Mental Health Hospital in The Home (MHHiTH) (Mental Health) Guideline |              |          |                                   |

## Evening service

- The evening service for MHHiTH will run 17:00hrs - 20:30hrs.
- The team will comprise of nursing staff only with medical input provided by the duty medical officer (DMO)/Registrar for Mental Health
- Patients deemed as requiring a second visit based upon clinical need or late admissions to the MHHiTH virtual ward will be considered for visitation after 17:00hrs as per:
  - \* [RKPG Community/home visiting policy](#)
  - \* [SMHS Community/home visiting policy](#)
- The Shift Coordinator of the evening service will seek advice for clinical matters from DMO/Registrar for Mental Health.
- Staff will complete/update running sheet and email to appropriate stakeholders as per [RKPG MH HITH Communication and Documentation Procedure](#).

## Evening service handover and patients of concern

- The MHHiTH Shift Coordinator will give a brief handover via email on a running sheet (see Appendix A) to the Shift Coordinator on Mimidi Park ward for MHHiTH prior to completion of shift.
- A more detailed handover will be updated on the patients online iSOFT file in the iSoBAR section of nursing handover.
- The Shift Coordinator will verbally hand over any patient of concern to DMO/Registrar for Mental Health (afterhours) and Mimidi Park Shift Coordinator.
- MHHiTH Shift coordinator will ensure any clinical issues are noted in iSOFT as a primary reference and PSOLIS as secondary reference, and hard copy of the notes which will be kept in the MHHiTH Clinical office.
- Staff will complete/update running sheet and email to appropriate stakeholders/shift coordinator of Mimidi Park as per [RKPG MH HITH Communication and Documentation Procedure](#).
- Staff managing these patients should be familiar with:
  - \* [RKPG Care of the Person Who May Be Suicidal \(Acute\) Policy](#)
  - \* [RKPG Prevention and Management of Violence and Aggression \(Acute\) Policy](#)

## Afterhours support

The Afterhours support is from 20:30hrs until 08:00hrs.

- There will be no home visit afterhours.
- On admission to MHHiTH, all patients/carers will be provided with a MHHiTH online resources which will include contact numbers for urgent matters; these will include afterhours number which will be the Clinical Nurse Manager (CNM) phone which will be diverted to Mimidi Park Shift Coordinator phone.
- The Shift Coordinator on Mimidi Park adult inpatient ward will be responsible for the taking and triaging of these calls.
- The Shift Coordinator of Mimidi Park adult inpatient ward will be required to use clinical decision making to determine whether a patient requires escalation to the

| RESPONSIBILITY    |                                                                                                                           |              |          | NATIONAL STANDARDS            |
|-------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|--------------|----------|-------------------------------|
| First Issued      | Mar 2021                                                                                                                  | Revisions    | NA       | National Standards<br>1, 5, 6 |
| This version      | Sep 2021                                                                                                                  | Revision Due | Sep 2024 |                               |
| Responsibility of | Co-Directors<br>Mental Health                                                                                             | Endorsed by  | DONM/DCS |                               |
| Title             | Evening and Afterhours Responsibilities relating to Mental Health Hospital in The Home (MHHiTH) (Mental Health) Guideline |              |          |                               |

DMO/Registrar for Mental Health for Rockingham General Hospital (RGH), or other alternative escalation. See '**Emergencies**' in this document.

- The DMO/Registrar for Mental Health for RGH will be responsible for receiving the triaged calls referred from Shift Coordinator of Mimidi Park adult inpatient ward, for matters that are deemed **urgent or crisis, that do not require escalation to emergency services**.

#### Afterhours support handover

- Mimidi Park Shift Coordinator will, if required, update running sheet for MHHiTH and save to W-drive and email to relevant stakeholders.
- MHHiTH patients will be handed over to the oncoming Mimidi Park Shift Coordinator via running sheet.
- Any issues patients of concern will be highlighted and escalated to oncoming MHHiTH Medical Team as required.
- DMO/Registrar for Mental Health will hand over any patients of concern to the MHHiTH Medical Team via phone.

#### **Weekend/public holiday service**

- The weekend/public holiday service will provide in hours home visiting service comprising of allocated nurses and/or MO.
- The evening service for weekends and public holidays will be based upon staffing capacity and bed numbers in the service.
- If there is no evening service, the handover will be given as per afterhours support to DMO/Registrar for Mental Health and Mimidi Park Shift Coordinator.
- Running sheet will be completed/updated, saved on W-drive and emailed to appropriate stakeholders.
- Weekend service will not offer pharmacy or social work support.

#### **Crisis plans**

- All MHHiTH patients will have a 'CRISIS PLAN' on PSOLIS to advise and manage patients who call afterhours in a crisis.
- The plan is available electronically on PSOLIS (with their management plan) and a hard copy printed and located with nursing care plans located with the file in the MHHiTH office.
- PSOLIS service events details and plans need to be up to date and accessible for accessible Mental Health Emergency Response Line (MHERL) should they be required to assess a situation/patient in the community.

| RESPONSIBILITY    |                                                                                                                           |              |          | NATIONAL STANDARDS            |
|-------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|--------------|----------|-------------------------------|
| First Issued      | Mar 2021                                                                                                                  | Revisions    | NA       | National Standards<br>1, 5, 6 |
| This version      | Sep 2021                                                                                                                  | Revision Due | Sep 2024 |                               |
| Responsibility of | Co-Directors<br>Mental Health                                                                                             | Endorsed by  | DONM/DCS |                               |
| Title             | Evening and Afterhours Responsibilities relating to Mental Health Hospital in The Home (MHHiTH) (Mental Health) Guideline |              |          |                               |

### **Emergencies**

- Some situations may require external emergency services such as ambulance/ police to be called (call 000) or for Mental Health emergencies the MHERL on 1300 555 788.
- MHERL can provide information, consultation and advice regarding the situation but will not provide clinicians to the home.
- MHERL may advise the relevant Acute Assessment Team (ATT) team to assess or attend in working hours.
- MHERL can advise and make a referral to the Police Co-Response Team if before 2200hrs if appropriate.
- All urgent matters will be escalated to the on call MO/Psychiatrist with input from the DMO outside of hours.

### **Documentation**

- Details of the MHHiTH patient crisis management are to be clearly detailed on the shift reports on iSOFT and in PSOLIS and printed off and put in file to ensure the relevant MHHiTH clinicians or PLN afterhours, provide follow up the next day.

### **Compliance monitoring**

Compliance with this procedure will be monitored by any clinical incidents via Datix.

| RESPONSIBILITY    |                                                                                                                           |              |          | NATIONAL STANDARDS            |
|-------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|--------------|----------|-------------------------------|
| First Issued      | Mar 2021                                                                                                                  | Revisions    | NA       | National Standards<br>1, 5, 6 |
| This version      | Sep 2021                                                                                                                  | Revision Due | Sep 2024 |                               |
| Responsibility of | Co-Directors<br>Mental Health                                                                                             | Endorsed by  | DONM/DCS |                               |
| Title             | Evening and Afterhours Responsibilities relating to Mental Health Hospital in The Home (MHHiTH) (Mental Health) Guideline |              |          |                               |

## References

1. Australian Commission on Safety and Quality in Health Care (ACSQH). The National Safety and Quality Health Service Standards Safety and Quality Improvement Guide: Standard 1 Governance for Safety and Quality in Health Service Organisations. 2nd ed. (Version 2) 2021. Available from <https://www.safetyandquality.gov.au/our-work/assessment-to-the-nsqhs-standards/>

## Links

[DoH Acceptable Use of Information and Communications Technology Policy](#)  
[DOH Chief Psychiatrist's Standards for Clinical Care](#)  
[DoH Information and Communications Technology Governance Policy](#)  
[DoH Information Security Policy](#)  
[Department of Health \(DoH\) State-wide Standardised Clinical Documentation \(SSCD\) for Mental Health Services](#)  
[RKPG Care of the person who may be suicidal Policy](#)  
[RKPG Clinical Handover-Nursing Midwifery \(Acute\) Guideline](#)  
[RKPG Community/Home Visiting Policy](#)  
[RKPG Communication and Documentation Policy MH HITH](#)  
[RKPG Medical Clinical handover \(Acute\) Policy](#)  
[RKPG Physical Health Care: Community Mental Health Consumers \(Mental Health\) Policy and Procedure](#)  
[RKPG Prevention and Management of Violence and Aggression Policy](#)  
[RKPG Referral, Admission and Discharge: MH HITH](#)  
[RKPG Telehealth: Community Mental Health \(Mental Health\) Guideline](#)  
[SMHS Community/home visiting Policy](#)

## National Standards



| RESPONSIBILITY    |                                                                                                                              |              |          | NATIONAL STANDARDS            |
|-------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|--------------|----------|-------------------------------|
| First Issued      | Mar 2021                                                                                                                     | Revisions    | NA       | National Standards<br>1, 5, 6 |
| This version      | Sep 2021                                                                                                                     | Revision Due | Sep 2024 |                               |
| Responsibility of | Co-Directors<br>Mental Health                                                                                                | Endorsed by  | DONM/DCS |                               |
| Title             | Evening and Afterhours Responsibilities relating to Mental Health<br>Hospital in The Home (MHHiTH) (Mental Health) Guideline |              |          |                               |

**Appendix A: MHHiTH Running sheet for handover**

|                                                                                                                                   |                 |                                |                  |                               |
|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------------|--------------------------------|------------------|-------------------------------|
| RkPG Mental Health Services: MHHiTH Running Sheet                                                                                 |                 | Date:                          | Shift:           |                               |
| Staff Name:                                                                                                                       |                 | Designation:                   |                  |                               |
| <b>Inpatients :</b>                                                                                                               |                 |                                |                  |                               |
| Name & AGE                                                                                                                        | URMN<br>Suburb  | Presenting problem/<br>History | Plan/Outcome     | Expected Discharge Date (EDD) |
|                                                                                                                                   |                 | Admission date:                | Risk:            |                               |
|                                                                                                                                   |                 | Admission date:                | Risk:            |                               |
|                                                                                                                                   |                 | Admission date:                | Risk:            |                               |
|                                                                                                                                   |                 | Admission date:                | Risk:            |                               |
|                                                                                                                                   |                 | Admission date:                | Risk:            |                               |
|                                                                                                                                   |                 | Admission date:                | Risk:            |                               |
|                                                                                                                                   |                 | Admission date:                | Risk:            |                               |
|                                                                                                                                   |                 | Admission date:                | Risk:            |                               |
| <b>Discharges:</b>                                                                                                                |                 |                                |                  |                               |
| Name & Age                                                                                                                        | URM<br>Suburb   |                                |                  |                               |
|                                                                                                                                   |                 |                                |                  |                               |
| <b>Wait listed Patients Prioritised for the service :</b>                                                                         |                 |                                |                  |                               |
| Name & AGE                                                                                                                        | URM &<br>Suburb | Presenting Problem:            | Current Location |                               |
|                                                                                                                                   |                 |                                |                  |                               |
| Template available on W-Drive in GDD file under "MHHiTH Running Sheet". Please save this in W-Drive under "MHHiTH Running Sheet " |                 |                                |                  |                               |

| RESPONSIBILITY    |                                                                                                                           |              |          | NATIONAL STANDARDS            |
|-------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|--------------|----------|-------------------------------|
| First Issued      | Mar 2021                                                                                                                  | Revisions    | NA       | National Standards<br>1, 5, 6 |
| This version      | Sep 2021                                                                                                                  | Revision Due | Sep 2024 |                               |
| Responsibility of | Co-Directors<br>Mental Health                                                                                             | Endorsed by  | DONM/DCS |                               |
| Title             | Evening and Afterhours Responsibilities relating to Mental Health Hospital in The Home (MHHiTH) (Mental Health) Guideline |              |          |                               |